



KirkMacKinnon

Ph.D. Candidate

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 Molecular & Cellular Biology
Program, UMASS Amherst

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 kirkmackinnon

About me

I am a molecular & computational biologist trained in the preparation and analysis of RNA-seq, ChIP-seq, DAP-seq, ATAC-seq, and GWA datasets. I am passionate about learning and staying up to date with the literature. I have a proven performance history of competent, publication worthy analyses in several different sequencing related disciplines.

Education

2011-2015 Bachelor of Science in Biology
Amherst, MA

UMASS Amherst

Research Experience

2015-Current Investigating the transcriptional regulation of growth in the model
grass *Brachypodium distachyon*. Hazen Lab
Ph.D candidate

2013-2015 Conducted time-lapse image analysis of *Brachypodium distachyon* in response to altered abiotic conditions. Hazen Lab
Research Assistant

Teaching

2018-2020 Introductory Biology 1 (BIO 151). Graduate Teaching Assistant

Awards

2021 Howard E. and Margaret E. Barr Bigelow Memorial Scholarship.
2021 Lotta M. Crabtree Fellowship in Production Agriculture.
2020 Center for Agriculture, Food and the Environment Fellowship.
2019 Lotta M. Crabtree Fellowship in Production Agriculture.
2018 Center for Agriculture, Food and the Environment Fellowship.
2015 Outstanding Biology Research Award.
2013-2015 UMass Amherst Dean's List.

Publications

- 2021 Touch-triggered bZIP translocation regulates elongation and secondary wall biosynthesis
Joshua H. Coomey, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Pubudu P. Handakumbura, Ian W. McCahill, Gina M. Trabucco, Jessica Mazzola, Nicole A. Leblanc, Rithany Kheam, Miriam Hernandez-Romero, Kerrie Barry, Lifeng Liu, Ji E. Lee, John P. Vogel, Ronan C. O'Malley, James J. Chambers, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.1101/2021.02.03.429573>
- 2020 Changes in ambient temperature are the prevailing cue in determining *Brachypodium distachyon* diurnal gene regulation New Phytologist
Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Benjamin J. Cole, Chang Yu, Joshua H. Coomey, Nolan T. Hartwick, Marie-Stanislas Remigereau, Tomás Duffy, Todd P. Michael, Steve A. Kay, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.1111/nph.16507>
- 2018 SECONDARY WALL ASSOCIATED MYB 1 is a positive regulator of secondary cell wall thickening in *Brachypodium distachyon* and is not found in the Brassicaceae The Plant Journal
Pubudu P. Handakumbura, Kathryn Brow, Ian P. Whitney, Kangmei Zhao, Karen A. Sanguinet, Scott J. Lee, Jennifer Olins, Sandra P. Romero-Gamboa, Michael J. Harrington, Carlisle J. Bascom, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Michael T. Veling, Lifeng Liu, Ji E. Lee, John P. Vogel, Ronan C. O'Malley, Magdalena Bezanilla, Laura E. Bartley, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.1111/tpj.14047>
- 2018 Secondary Wall Regulating NACs Differentially Bind at the Promoter at a CELLULOSE SYNTHASE A4 Cis-eQTL Frontiers in Plant Science
Jennifer R. Olins, Li Lin, Scott J. Lee, Gina M. Trabucco, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpls.2018.01895>
- 2014 Daily Changes in Temperature, Not the Circadian Clock, Regulate Growth Rate in *Brachypodium distachyon* PLoS ONE
Dominick A. Matos, Benjamin J. Cole, Ian P. Whitney, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Steve A. Kay, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0100072>

Conference Presentations

Talks

- 2018** Exploring Diurnal Rhythmic Gene Expression in *Brachypodium distachyon*. ASPB Northeastern Section Meeting
Kirk J-M. MacKinnon, Benjamin J. Cole, Chang Yu, Marie Remigereau, Tomás Duffy, Steve A. Kay and Samuel P. Hazen.

Posters

- 2019** Changes in ambient temperature are the prevailing cue in determining *Brachypodium distachyon* diurnal gene regulation. Annual Symposium in Plant Biology
Kirk J-M. MacKinnon, Benjamin J. Cole, Chang Yu, Joshua H. Coomey, Nolan T. Hartwick, Marie-Stanislas Remigereau, Tomás Duffy, Todd P. Michael, Steve A. Kay, Samuel P. Hazen.
- 2019** Exploring Diurnal Rhythmic Gene Expression in *Brachypodium distachyon*. PAG XXVII
Kirk J-M. MacKinnon, Benjamin J. Cole, Chang Yu, Marie Remigereau, Tomás Duffy, Steve A. Kay and Samuel P. Hazen.
- 2014** Daily Changes in Temperature, Not the Circadian Clock, Regulate Growth Rate in *Brachypodium distachyon* UMass Undergraduate Research Symposium
Dominick A. Matos, Benjamin J. Cole, Ian P. Whitney, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Steve A. Kay, Samuel P. Hazen.

Mentoring & Outreach

Train and mentor undergraduate assistants in the Hazen Lab

2020-Current Sanyam Shilpakar.

2017-2019 Chang Yu.

2018-2019 Alden Nichols.

2018-2018 Jacob Scott.

2017-2017 Crysta Daniels.

Creation of online tools for data exploration

Timecourse RNA-seq

<https://hazenlab.shinyapps.io/shinyapp/>

Touch Responsive Timecourse RNA-seq

<https://hazenlab.shinyapps.io/swiztc/>

Gain and loss of function RNA-seq

<https://hazenlab.shinyapps.io/snd2r/>